

# Religion — Course Syllabus

Grade 8: The Story of Our Church · Church History · Mary, Star of the Sea School · SY 2026-2027

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## Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

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## Course Description

This course is based on the ministry of catechesis for religious education and faith formation: **believe, worship, live, and pray**. Students learn the doctrine of the Catholic Church and establish a common language of faith, engage in understanding the sacramental life of the Catholic Church, focus attention on the moral teachings of the Church, and experience a wide variety of prayers. Students will develop a deeper understanding of faith and greater love for God.

**Schoolwide Learning Expectation (SLE):** MSOS students will become active Christians who respect others, make good choices, value prayer, and practice the teachings of the Catholic Church.

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### Teacher

**Mrs. Corazon Aczon**

Email: [caczon@starofthesea.org](mailto:caczon@starofthesea.org)

*"They that hope in the Lord will renew their strength, they will soar on eagle's wings; they will run and not grow weary, walk and not grow faint." — Isaiah 40:31*

### Classroom Materials

- *Blest Are We* textbook
  - Holy Bible · [usccb.org](http://usccb.org)
  - Computer / device
  - Composition notebook
  - Pencils, pens, agenda
  - Colored pencils, highlighters
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## Course Outline — Grade 8: The Story of Our Church (Church History)

### Unit 1 — The Marks of the Church

One, Holy, Catholic, Apostolic · Early Church, persecutions, Church Fathers, Council of Nicaea

### Unit 2 — The Growth of Christendom

St. Benedict and monasticism · missionaries to Europe · Charlemagne · Great Schism (1054)

### Unit 3 — The Age of Faith and Beauty

Gothic cathedrals · Sts. Francis, Dominic, Aquinas · universities · Crusades and pilgrimage

### Unit 4 — Reason, Rebellion, and Reform

Reformation · Council of Trent · Counter-Reformation saints (Ignatius, Teresa, John of the Cross)

### Unit 5 — Returning to the Roots of Christianity

Vatican II · Catholic Social Teaching · modern saints · the universal call to holiness

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## Evaluation / Assessment

| 20%             | 30%             | 30%                        | 10%      | 10%      |
|-----------------|-----------------|----------------------------|----------|----------|
| Tests & Quizzes | Quarterly Tests | Participation / Recitation | Homework | Projects |

Total: 100%

## Student Absence

Students are responsible for turning in homework, assignments, and projects, and arranging with the teacher a specific time to make up any quizzes or tests missed due to absence.

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## How We Nurture Our Faith in Religion Class

- Praying and singing hymns
- Reading Scripture and memorizing Bible verses
- Praying from the Book of Psalms
- Writing “Dear God” journal entries
- Reflecting on the Readings and Gospel of the Day
- Discussing activities from the *Blest Are We* textbook
- Role-playing Bible stories (e.g., the Christmas story)
- Learning about the Lives of Saints as models of faith
- Praying the Rosary, Stations of the Cross, and other devotions
- Integrating Religion and Art by illustrating Bible verses
- Participating in the Sacraments and Liturgical Year as church ministers (lectors, choir, altar servers)

**+ GOD BLESS YOU! +**